

February

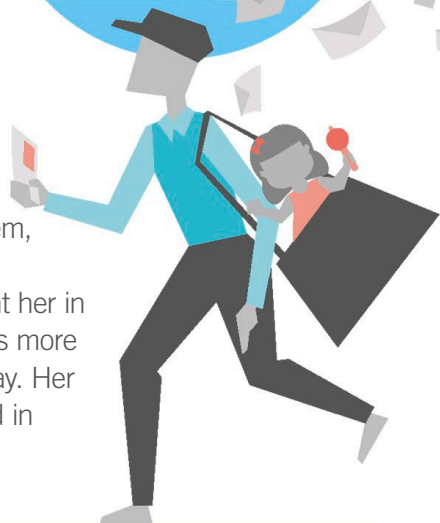
19



1914

Special delivery

Taking advantage of the inexpensive US postal system, the parents of four-year-old Charlotte May Pierstorff sent her in the mail to her grandparents more than 117 km (73 miles) away. Her train journey was chronicled in the book *Mailing May*.



Born this day

1473 Nicolaus Copernicus, Polish genius. He was not only an accomplished astronomer, but also a mathematician, physician, economist, translator, and diplomat.

Also on this day

1600 The Huaynaputina volcano erupted in the Andes mountains of Peru, killing about 1,500 people and destroying surrounding villages.

1942 Executive Order 9066 was issued by US president Franklin D Roosevelt for Japanese-Americans to be locked up in concentration camps during World War II.

2008 The world's longest-serving political leader, Cuban president Fidel Castro, resigned after 31 years in power.

1977

Seafloor discovery

Hydrothermal deep-sea vents, found on the seafloor, were seen for the first time by scientists on board the US submersible *Alvin* in the Galápagos Rift in the Pacific Ocean. The nutrient-rich hot springs provide a unique habitat for clams and crabs.

